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Technologies for untrusted code execution with processor sandbox support

Abstract

Technologies for untrusted code execution include a computing device having a processor with sandbox support. The computing device executes code included in a native domain in a non-privileged, native processor mode. The computing device may invoke a sandbox jump processor instruction during execution of the code in the native domain to enter a sandbox domain. The computing device executes code in the sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to invoking the sandbox jump instruction. While executing in the sandbox processor mode, the processor denies access to memory outside of the sandbox domain and may deny execution of one or more prohibited instructions. From the sandbox domain, the computing device may execute a sandbox exit instruction to exit the sandbox domain and resume execution in the native domain. The computing device may execute processor instructions to configure the sandbox domain. Other embodiments are described and claimed.

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Background/Summary

CLAIM TO PRIORITY (1) This Application is a continuation of and claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. application Ser. No. 17/367,106, entitled TECHNOLOGIES FOR UNTRUSTED CODE EXECUTION WITH PROCESSOR SANDBOX SUPPORT, by Mingwei Zhang, et al., filed Jul. 2, 2021, now allowed, which is a continuation of and claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. application Ser. No. 15/720,083, entitled TECHNOLOGIES FOR UNTRUSTED CODE EXECUTION WITH PROCESSOR SANDBOX SUPPORT, by Mingwei Zhang, et al., filed Sep. 29, 2017, now issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,055,401, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Typical computing devices may execute numerous small, untrusted code components. For example, a computing device may execute plugins, applets, applications, or other third-party code components downloaded from the Internet. In current computing devices, untrusted code may be separated from trusted code by a process boundary or a ring boundary. Intel® page protection keys may protect a small number (e.g., 16) of domains of a process address space from accidental read or write memory access, for example caused by programming errors. Page protection keys may not protect from malicious attackers that manipulate the protection keys themselves. Typical computing devices may also implement software-based isolation to execute untrusted code within a user process. For example, Google® Native Client (NaCl) implements a custom toolchain to ensure that code executed within a software-based sandbox cannot jump out of the sandbox, except through specific trampoline routines.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The concepts described herein are illustrated by way of example and not by way of limitation in the accompanying figures. For simplicity and clarity of illustration, elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. Where considered appropriate, reference labels have been repeated among the figures to indicate corresponding or analogous elements.

(2) FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of at least one embodiment of a computing device for untrusted code execution;

(3) FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram of at least one embodiment of an environment that may be established by the computing device of FIG. 1;

(4) FIGS. 3A and 3B are a simplified flow diagram of at least one embodiment of a method for untrusted code execution that may be executed by the computing device of FIGS. 1-2; and

(5) FIG. 4 is a simplified flow diagram of at least one embodiment of a method for exception handling that may be executed by the computing device of FIGS. 1-2.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(6) While the concepts of the present disclosure are susceptible to various modifications and alternative forms, specific embodiments thereof have been shown by way of example in the drawings and will be described herein in detail. It should be understood, however, that there is no intent to limit the concepts of the present disclosure to the particular forms disclosed, but on the contrary, the intention is to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives consistent with the present disclosure and the appended claims.

(7) References in the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an illustrative embodiment,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may or may not necessarily include that particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it is submitted that it is within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to effect such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described. Additionally, it should be appreciated that items included in a list in the form of “at least one of A, B, and C” can mean (A); (B); (C); (A and B); (A and C); (B and C); or (A, B, and C). Similarly, items listed in the form of “at least one of A, B, or C” can mean (A); (B); (C); (A and B); (A and C); (B and C); or (A, B, and C).

(8) The disclosed embodiments may be implemented, in some cases, in hardware, firmware, software, or any combination thereof. The disclosed embodiments may also be implemented as instructions carried by or stored on one or more transitory or non-transitory machine-readable (e.g., computer-readable) storage media, which may be read and executed by one or more processors. A machine-readable storage medium may be embodied as any storage device, mechanism, or other physical structure for storing or transmitting information in a form readable by a machine (e.g., a volatile or non-volatile memory, a media disc, or other media device).

(9) In the drawings, some structural or method features may be shown in specific arrangements and/or orderings. However, it should be appreciated that such specific arrangements and/or orderings may not be required. Rather, in some embodiments, such features may be arranged in a different manner and/or order than shown in the illustrative figures. Additionally, the inclusion of a structural or method feature in a particular figure is not meant to imply that such feature is required in all embodiments and, in some embodiments, may not be included or may be combined with other features.

(10) Referring now to FIG. 1, in an illustrative embodiment, a computing device **100** for untrusted code execution is shown. As shown, the computing device **100** includes a processor **120** that includes sandbox support **122**. In use, as described in more detail below, the computing device **100** executes unprivileged code (e.g., user-level code) from a native domain in a native processor mode. The computing device **100** may add memory pages to one or more sandbox domains and then jump to an entry point within the sandbox domain using the sandbox support **122**. The computing device **100** executes the code within the sandbox domain in a sandbox processor mode, in which memory accesses outside of the sandbox domain as well as certain processor instructions are disallowed. The computing device **100** may jump back to the native domain using the sandbox support **122**. The native domain and the sandbox domains may be included in the same virtual address space. Thus, the computing device **100** may enable user-level configuration and management of multiple untrusted sandbox domains. The computing device **100** may provide memory protection for different domains in the same address space, without requiring potentially expensive context switches or permission level changes (e.g., ring level changes, hypercalls, or other security boundary crossings). Thus, the computing device **100** may improve performance for certain applications, particularly for workloads that perform frequent cross-boundary interactions.

Additionally, the computing device **100** may perform sandbox isolation without extensive, specialized toolchain support (e.g., without extensive changes to the compiler, linker, or other toolchain components) and, by removing software overhead, may provide improved performance over software-only isolation techniques.

(11) The computing device **100** may be embodied as any type of computation or computer device capable of performing the functions described herein, including, without limitation, a computer, a multiprocessor system, a server, a rack-mounted server, a blade server, a laptop computer, a notebook computer, a tablet computer, a wearable computing device, a network appliance, a web appliance, an embedded system, a distributed computing system, a processor-based system, and/or a consumer electronic device. As shown in FIG. **1**, the computing device **100** illustratively includes a processor **120**, an input/output subsystem **124**, a memory **126**, a data storage device **128**, and a communication subsystem **130**. Of course, the computing device **100** may include other or additional components, such as those commonly found in a server (e.g., various input/output devices), in other embodiments. Additionally, in some embodiments, one or more of the illustrative components may be incorporated in, or otherwise form a portion of, another component. For example, the memory **126**, or portions thereof, may be incorporated in the processor **120** in some embodiments.

(12) The processor **120** may be embodied as any type of processor capable of performing the functions described herein. The processor **120** may be embodied as a single or multi-core processor(s), digital signal processor, microcontroller, or other processor or processing/controlling circuit. As shown, the processor **120** includes the sandbox support **122**. The sandbox support **122** may be embodied as any hardware, firmware, microcode, other resources of the processor **120** that provides sandbox protection as described further below. For example, the sandbox support **122** may include instruction set architecture (ISA) extensions, model-specific registers, and/or other processor features to support configuration of sandbox domains, entering and exiting sandboxing domains, and enforcing sandbox protections.

(13) Similarly, the memory **126** may be embodied as any type of volatile or non-volatile memory or data storage capable of performing the functions described herein. In operation, the memory **126** may store various data and software used during operation of the computing device **100** such as operating systems, applications, programs, libraries, and drivers. The memory **126** is communicatively coupled to the processor **120** via the I/O subsystem **124**, which may be embodied as circuitry and/or components to facilitate input/output operations with the processor **120**, the memory **126**, and other components of the computing device **100**. For example, the I/O subsystem **124** may be embodied as, or otherwise include, memory controller hubs, input/output control hubs, firmware devices, communication links (i.e., point-to-point links, bus links, wires, cables, light guides, printed circuit board traces, etc.) and/or other components and subsystems to facilitate the input/output operations. In some embodiments, the I/O subsystem **124** may form a portion of a system-on-a-chip (SoC) and be incorporated, along with the processors **120**, the memory **126**, and other components of the computing device **100**, on a single integrated circuit chip.

(14) The data storage device **128** may be embodied as any type of device or devices configured for short-term or long-term storage of data such as, for example, memory devices and circuits, memory cards, hard disk drives, solid-state drives, or other data storage devices. The communication subsystem **130** of the computing device **100** may be embodied as any communication circuit, device, or collection thereof, capable of enabling communications between the computing device **100** and other remote devices over a network. The communication subsystem **130** may be configured to use any one or more communication technology (e.g., wired or wireless communications) and associated protocols (e.g., Ethernet, Bluetooth®, Wi-Fi®, WiMAX, etc.) to effect such communication.

(15) As shown, the computing device **100** may also include one or more peripheral devices **132**. The peripheral devices **132** may include any number of additional input/output devices, interface

devices, and/or other peripheral devices. For example, in some embodiments, the peripheral devices **132** may include a display, touch screen, graphics circuitry, keyboard, mouse, speaker system, microphone, network interface, and/or other input/output devices, interface devices, and/or peripheral devices.

(16) Referring now to FIG. 2, in an illustrative embodiment, the computing device **100** establishes an environment **200** during operation. The illustrative environment **200** includes a trusted domain manager **206**, a system manager **212**, and the sandbox support **122** of the processor **120**. As shown, the sandbox support **122** further includes a sandbox enforcement engine **216**, a configuration engine **218**, a sandbox jump engine **220**, and a sandbox exit engine **222**. The various components of the environment **200** may be embodied as hardware, firmware, processor microcode, software, or a combination thereof. As such, in some embodiments, one or more of the components of the environment **200** may be embodied as circuitry or collection of electrical devices (e.g., trusted domain manager circuitry **206**, system manager circuitry **212**, sandbox enforcement circuitry **216**, configuration circuitry **218**, sandbox jump circuitry **220**, and/or sandbox exit circuitry **222**). It should be appreciated that, in such embodiments, one or more of the trusted domain manager circuitry **206**, the system manager circuitry **212**, the sandbox enforcement circuitry **216**, the configuration circuitry **218**, the sandbox jump circuitry **220**, and/or the sandbox exit circuitry **222** may form a portion of one or more of the processor **120**, the I/O subsystem **124**, and/or other components of the computing device **100**. Additionally, in some embodiments, one or more of the illustrative components may form a portion of another component and/or one or more of the illustrative components may be independent of one another.

(17) The trusted domain manager **206** may execute in a non-privileged operating mode (e.g., user mode or ring level 3). The trusted domain manager **206** is configured to execute code included in a native domain **208** in a non-privileged native processor mode. The trusted domain manager **206** is further configured to invoke a `sandbox_allocate` instruction while in the native processor mode to add one or more memory pages to a corresponding sandbox domain **202** and may be configured to invoke a `sandbox_free` instruction while in the native processor mode to remove one or more memory pages from a corresponding sandbox domain **202**. The trusted domain manager **206** may be configured to configure a sandbox state for a sandbox domain **202** and to invoke a `sandbox_set_state` instruction to set the sandbox state for the sandbox domain **202** while in the native processor mode. The trusted domain manager **206** is further configured to invoke a `sandbox_jump` instruction while in the native processor mode to enter a specified sandbox domain **202**.

(18) The trusted domain manager **206** is further configured to execute code included in a sandbox domain **202** in a non-privileged sandbox processor mode in response invoking the `sandbox_jump` instruction. The sandbox domain **202** is included in the same virtual address space as the native domain **208**, for example in the same process. Memory pages included in the sandbox domain **202** are not included in the native domain **208**. The illustrative environment **200** includes two sandbox domains **202a**, **202b**; however, in other embodiments the environment may include any number of sandbox domains **202**. The code included in the sandbox domain **202** may invoke a `sandbox_exit` instruction to exit the sandbox domain **202** while executing in the sandbox processor mode.

(19) The sandbox enforcement engine **216** is configured to enforce the sandbox processor mode by generating an exception in response to a sandbox violation. The sandbox enforcement engine **216** may be configured to allow access to memory included in the current sandbox domain **202** while executing in the sandbox processor mode and to deny access to memory not included in the current sandbox domain **202** (e.g., in the native domain **208** and/or other sandbox domains **202**). The sandbox enforcement engine **216** may deny read access, write access, and execute access to memory not included in the current sandbox domain **202**, for example by generating a page fault exception. The sandbox enforcement engine **216** may be further configured to deny execution of one or more prohibited instructions while executing in the sandbox processor mode, for example by

generating a general protection fault exception. The prohibited instructions may include, for example, all system call-related instructions.

(20) The configuration engine **218** is configured to configure a state control block **224** in the memory **126** in response to invoking a `sandbox_set_state` instruction. The state control block **224** may be embodied as a per-thread data structure in the memory **126**. The state control block **224** is managed by the processor **120**. The state control block **224** may be located in the normal domain **208** or in kernel space, or in some embodiments may be inaccessible to software executed by the computing device **100**. The state control block **224** may not be directly modified by any sandbox domain **202**. The state control block **224** may be configured to include a stack pointer that points within the sandbox domain **202**, an entry point within the sandbox domain **202**, or other sandbox state. The configuration engine **218** may also be configured to add or remove memory pages from a sandbox domain **202** in response to invoking a `sandbox_allocate` instruction or a `sandbox_free` instruction, respectively.

(21) The sandbox jump engine **220** is configured to set a sandbox bit in the state control block **224**, store a return address in the state control block **224**, load an execution state from the state control block **224**, and jump to an entry point within a sandbox domain **202** in response to invoking the `sandbox_jump` instruction. The return address stored in the state control block **224** points to an address within the native domain **208**. The sandbox exit engine **222** is configured to clear the sandbox bit in the state control block **224** and to jump to the return address stored in the state control block **224** in response to invoking a `sandbox_exit` instruction.

(22) The system manager **212** may be embodied as or otherwise include an operating system, hypervisor, virtual machine monitor, and/or other privileged management component of the computing device **100**. Thus, the system manager **212** may execute in a privileged operating mode (e.g., kernel mode or ring level 0). The system manager **212** is configured to execute a kernel exception handler **214** in a privileged processor mode in response to an exception generated by the processor **120**. The system manager **212** may be configured to invoke a non-privileged exception handler **210** in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to execution of the kernel exception handler **214**. The trusted domain manager **206** may be further configured to read a sandbox status register of the processor **120** in response to executing the non-privileged exception handler **210** and determine whether the exception originated in the non-privileged sandbox processor mode. If the exception originated in the sandbox processor mode, the trusted domain manager **206** may be further configured to invoke the `sandbox_jump` processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode to execute a sandbox domain exception handler **204**. The trusted domain manager **206** may perform one or more checks before entering the non-privileged sandbox processor mode. For example, if the exception is generated by untrusted code attempting to exit the sandbox domain **202**, the trusted domain manager **206** may not pass control back to the sandbox domain exception handler **204**.

(23) Referring now to FIGS. 3A and 3B, in use, the computing device **100** may execute a method **300** for untrusted code execution. It should be appreciated that, in some embodiments, the operations of the method **300** may be performed by one or more components of the environment **200** of the computing device **100** as shown in FIG. 2. The method **300** begins in block **302**, in which the computing device **100** executes code from the native domain **208** in a user-level, native processor mode. For example, the processor **120** may execute in a non-privileged mode such as ring level 3. The processor **120** executes code in the normal domain **208** without sandboxing enabled, for example, with the sandbox bit of the state control block **224** cleared.

(24) In block **304**, the computing device **100** invokes a `sandbox_allocate` instruction to add one or more memory pages to a sandbox domain **202**. For example, an application executing in the normal domain **208** may add memory pages associated with a downloaded applet, plug-in, or other untrusted code to the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may invoke the instruction with one or more parameters, including a linear address or other identifier of the memory page to

add to the sandbox domain **202** as well as a domain identifier of the sandbox domain **202**. The processor **120** may use any technique to track or otherwise add the memory page to the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may invoke the `sandbox_allocate` instruction multiple times to add additional memory pages to the sandbox domain **202**. The processor **120** may return an error if a memory page has already been allocated to a different sandbox domain **202**.

(25) In block **306**, the computing device **100** configures the state for the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may, for example, configure initial values that will be loaded into all of the general purpose registers of the processor **120** when entering the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may configure the state in the memory **126**, for example in an in-memory data structure in the normal domain **208**. In block **308**, the computing device **100** sets a stack pointer value (e.g., RSP, ESP, or other stack pointer register). The stack pointer value pointers to an address within the sandbox domain **202** that will be used for stack space during execution in the sandbox domain **202**. In block **310**, the computing device **100** sets an entry point (e.g., RIP, EIP, or other instruction pointer register). The entry point may be embodied as an address within the sandbox domain **202**.

(26) In block **312**, the computing device **100** invokes a `sandbox_set_state` processor instruction to set the state for the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may invoke the instruction with one or more parameters, including a pointer to a data structure that includes the state as well as the domain identifier of the sandbox domain **202**. In block **314**, the processor **120** configures the state control block **224** based on the provided state data. The processor **120** may, for example, copy one or more values to the state control block **224**, including the stack pointer value and entry point value.

(27) In block **316**, the computing device **100** invokes a `sandbox_jump` instruction to switch to the sandbox domain **202** at the entry point address. The sandbox jump instruction may be executed in an unprivileged (e.g., user-mode), native processor mode. The computing device **100** may invoke the instruction with one or more parameters, including a linear address or other identifier of a memory page in the sandbox domain **202**. For example, parameters may be used to indicate when the sandbox domain **202** is entered for the first time, when the sandbox domain **202** is entered to return to a saved state in the sandbox, and/or when an exception handler in the sandbox domain **202** is executed. In those examples, the parameter may identify the state control block **224**, and the state control block **224** may include an ordinary entry point, an exception handling entry point, and an exception bit. When the exception bit is cleared, the processor **120** may jump to the ordinary entry point, and when the exception bit is set the processor **120** may jump to the exception handling entry point.

(28) In block **318**, in response to invoking the `sandbox_jump` instruction, the processor **120** sets a sandbox bit in the state control block **224**. Setting the sandbox bit indicates that the processor **120** is executing in the sandbox mode and thus enforces sandbox protections. In block **320** the processor **120** stores a return address in the state control block **224**. The return address may be any address within the native domain **208** at which native (i.e., non-sandboxed) execution may resume. For example, the return address may be the address of the next instruction following the `sandbox_jump` instruction. In block **322**, the processor **120** loads state from the state control block **224**. For example, the processor **120** may load values for all general-purpose registers, including the stack pointer and instruction pointer, from the state control block **224**. In block **324**, the processor **120** jumps to the entry point address within the sandbox domain **202**.

(29) In block **326**, shown in FIG. 3B, the computing device **100** executes code from the sandbox domain **202** in a user-level, sandbox processor mode. For example, the processor **120** may execute in a non-privileged mode such as ring level 3. The computing device **100** may execute the sandbox domain **202** in the same virtual address space as the native domain **208** (e.g., in the same process space) and thus may continue execution without a context switch or ring level transition. While executing in the sandbox mode, the processor **120** enforces sandbox protections.

(30) In block **328**, the processor **120** allows code and/or data accesses to memory pages within the current sandbox domain **202**. For example, the processor **120** may allow read, write, and execute access to memory addresses within the current sandbox domain **202**. Of course, the processor **120** may continue to apply page table (or extended page table) permissions to the memory accesses. In block **330**, the processor **120** may deny code and/or data access to memory pages outside of the current sandbox domain. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **2**, when executing in the sandbox domain **202a**, the processor **120** may deny read, write, and execute access to memory locations within the native domain **208** or within any other sandbox domains **202** (e.g., the sandbox domain **202b**). The processor **120** may deny access by generating an exception such as a page fault exception. One method for exception handling that may be executed by the computing device **100** is described below in connection with FIG. **4**.

(31) In block **332**, the processor **120** may deny execution of one or more prohibited instructions. The prohibited instructions may include instructions that generate a software interrupt or otherwise attempt to exit user-level code such as SYSCALL, INT, VMCALL, or similar instructions. The prohibited instructions may also include instructions that flush the cache, such as RDTSC. The prohibited instructions may also include instructions that manage sandbox domains **202**, such as sandbox_allocate, sandbox_free, sandbox_set_state, or sandbox_jump. The processor **120** may deny execution of a prohibited instruction by generating an exception such as a general protection fault exception. One method for exception handling that may be executed by the computing device **100** is described below in connection with FIG. **4**.

(32) The computing device **100** continues to execute user-mode code from the sandbox domain **202** in a user-level, sandbox processor mode until, in block **334**, the computing device **100** invokes a sandbox_exit instruction to switch to the native domain **208** at the return address that was previously stored in the state control block **224**. Invoking the sandbox_exit instruction may be the exclusive technique for the sandbox code to request an exit from the sandbox domain **202** (without, for example, generating an exception or other error). The sandbox_exit instruction may be invoked, for example, to request a privileged service from the normal domain (e.g., to request file open, read, write, or close, to allocate or deallocate memory, or to perform other privileged operations). The native domain **208** code may apply one or more security policies or otherwise determine whether to service a request from the sandbox **204**. Note that timer interrupts (e.g., time slice expiration) and other interrupts to the kernel may be handled in kernel mode, without generating an exit from the sandbox domain. In some embodiments, the kernel may not be aware of the existence of the sandbox domain **204**. The sandbox_exit instruction may be invoked without any additional parameters. In block **336**, in response to executing the sandbox_exit instruction, the processor **120** clears the sandbox bit in the state control block **224**. Clearing the sandbox bit indicates that the processor **120** is executing in the native mode and thus does not enforce sandbox protections. In block **338**, the processor **120** jumps to the return address that was stored in the state control block **224**.

(33) In block **340**, in some embodiments, the computing device **100** may invoke a sandbox_free instruction to remove one or more memory pages from the sandbox domain **202**. For example, an application executing in the normal domain **208** may remove memory pages associated with a downloaded applet, plug-in, or other untrusted code from the sandbox domain **202** after execution of the untrusted code is completed. The computing device **100** may invoke the instruction with one or more parameters, including a linear address or other identifier of the memory page to remove from the sandbox domain **202** as well as the domain identifier of the sandbox domain **202**. The processor **120** may use any technique to remove the memory page from the sandbox domain **202**. The computing device **100** may invoke the sandbox_free instruction multiple times to remove additional memory pages from the sandbox domain **202**. After removing any memory pages, the method **300** loops back to block **302**, shown in FIG. **3A**, to continue executing untrusted code.

(34) Referring now to FIG. **4**, in use, the computing device **100** may execute a method **400** for

exception handling. It should be appreciated that, in some embodiments, the operations of the method **400** may be performed by one or more components of the environment **200** of the computing device **100** as shown in FIG. 2. The method **400** begins in block **402**, in which the computing device **100** generates an exception, fault, interrupt, trap, or other exceptional condition. The exception may be generated while executing in the sandbox mode, for example in response to a sandbox violation, or in other circumstances.

(35) In block **404**, the processor **120** invokes the kernel exception handler **214**. The processor **120** may perform a typical interrupt handling process, for example by pushing an interrupt frame onto the kernel stack and then invoking the exception handler **214** in a privileged processor mode, such as ring level 0. Because the kernel exception handler **214** executes in a privileged mode, the processor **120** does not enforce sandbox protections. In block **406**, the kernel exception handler **214** invokes a sandbox handler in the user mode. For example, the kernel exception handler **214** may invoke the native domain exception handler **210**. The native domain exception handler **210** may be registered with the kernel exception handler **214** by the native domain **208** and thus may be trusted. The kernel exception handler **214** may clear the sandbox bit in the state control block **224**, allowing the user-mode code to execute in the normal mode (and not the sandbox mode).

(36) In block **408**, the native domain exception handler **212** reads a sandbox status model-specific register (MSR) of the processor **120** to determine if the exception originated from a sandbox domain **202**. When the exception is generated, the processor **120** sets the sandbox status MSR to indicate whether the exception originates from a sandbox domain **202**. In block **410**, the kernel exception handler **214** determines whether the exception originated from a sandbox domain **202**. If not, the method **400** branches ahead to block **422**, described below. If the exception does originate from a sandbox domain **202**, the method **400** advances to block **412**.

(37) In block **412**, the user-mode native code sandbox handler **210** handles the sandbox exception. For example, the handler **210** may free or otherwise unload the sandbox domain **202** that generated the exception or otherwise handle the sandbox exception. In some embodiments, the user-mode native code sandbox handler **210** may perform one or more checks or other security policy determinations to determine whether to allow the exception to be handled by the sandbox domain **202**. For example, the sandbox domain **202** may be allowed to handle exceptions unless the exception was caused by code in the sandbox domain **202** attempting to exit the sandbox.

(38) In block **414**, the native domain exception handler **212** reads a sandbox handler field of the SCB to determine whether a sandbox exception handler has been designated. For example, the sandbox handler may be configured by the native domain to point to a sandbox exception handler **204** within the sandbox domain **204**. In block **416**, the native domain handler **212** determines whether to invoke a sandbox exception handler. For example, the sandbox handler field may be null or otherwise invalid if no sandbox exception handler has been designated. Alternatively, the native domain handler **210** may determine whether to invoke the sandbox exception handler based on one or more security policies or other factors. If a sandbox exception handler will not be invoked, the method **400** branches to block **422**, as described below. If a sandbox exception handler will be invoked, the method **400** advances to block **418**.

(39) In block **418** the user-mode native exception handler **210** may invoke a sandbox exception handler **204**. The sandbox exception handler **204** may be invoked in the sandbox mode, for example by invoking the `sandbox_jump` instruction. The sandbox exception handler **204** may perform any appropriate exception handling routines. After the native code sandbox handler **210** and/or the sandbox exception handler **204** handles the exception, the method **400** branches to block **420**, in which the computing device **100** returns from handling the exception. After returning, the method **400** is completed.

(40) Referring back to blocks **408**, **412**, if the exception did not originate from a sandbox or not sandbox exception handler is invoked, the method **400** may branch to block **422**. In block **422**, the computing device **100** performs a default exception handling routine. For example, the computing

device **100** may terminate the user-level process that generated the exception or perform other management operations. After performing the default exception handling routine, the method **400** branches to block **420**, in which the computing device **100** returns from handling the exception. After returning, the method **400** is completed.

(41) Although FIG. 4 illustrates that the native domain exception handler **210** reads the sandbox status MSR and determines whether to invoke a sandbox exception handler, it should be understood that in some embodiments those operations may be performed by one or more other components of the computing device **100**. For example, in some embodiments those operations may be performed by the kernel exception handler **214**.

(42) It should be appreciated that, in some embodiments, the methods **300** and/or **400** may be embodied as various instructions stored on a computer-readable media, which may be executed by the processor **120** and/or other components of the computing device **100** to cause the computing device **100** to perform the respective method **300** and/or **400**. The computer-readable media may be embodied as any type of media capable of being read by the computing device **100** including, but not limited to, the memory **126**, the data storage device **128**, firmware devices, other memory or data storage devices of the computing device **100**, portable media readable by a peripheral device **132** of the computing device **100**, and/or other media.

EXAMPLES

(43) Illustrative examples of the technologies disclosed herein are provided below. An embodiment of the technologies may include any one or more, and any combination of, the examples described below.

(44) Example 1 includes a computing device for untrusted code execution, the computing device comprising a trusted domain manager to: execute code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; invoke, during execution of the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain; invoke, during the execution of the code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invocation of the first processor instruction; and execute code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to invocation of the second processor instruction.

(45) Example 2 includes the subject matter of Examples 1, and wherein to execute the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises to: allow, by a processor of the computing device, access to memory included in the first sandbox domain; and deny, by the processor of the computing device, access to memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(46) Example 3 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1 and 2, and wherein to deny the access to memory comprises to deny read access, write access, and execute access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(47) Example 4 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-3, and wherein to deny the access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain comprises to generate, by the processor, a page fault exception.

(48) Example 5 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-4, and wherein to execute the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises to deny, by a processor of the computing device, execution of a prohibited instruction.

(49) Example 6 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-5, and wherein to deny the execution of the prohibited instruction comprises to generate, by the processor, a general protection fault exception.

(50) Example 7 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-6, and wherein the trusted domain manager is further to: configure, during the execution of the user-mode code in the native processor mode, a sandbox state for the first sandbox domain; and invoke a third processor instruction to set

the sandbox state for the first sandbox domain in response to configuration of the sandbox state; wherein to invoke the second processor instruction comprises to invoke the second processor instruction in response to invocation of the third processor instruction.

(51) Example 8 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-7, and wherein the sandbox state is indicative of a stack pointer that points within the first sandbox domain and an entry point within the first sandbox domain.

(52) Example 9 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-8, and further comprising a processor, wherein the processor includes a configuration engine to configure a state control block in a memory of the computing device with the sandbox state in response to invocation of the third processor instruction.

(53) Example 10 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-9, and further comprising a processor, wherein the processor includes a sandbox jump engine to: set a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invocation of the second processor instruction; store a return address in the memory of the computing device in response to the invocation of the second processor instruction; load an execution state from the memory of the computing device in response to the invocation of the second processor instruction; and jump to an entry point within the first sandbox domain in response to the invocation of the second processor instruction.

(54) Example 11 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-10, and wherein to load the execution state comprises to: load a stack pointer from the memory to a stack pointer register of the processor; and load the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the processor.

(55) Example 12 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-11, and wherein: to set the sandbox bit comprises to set a sandbox bit of a state control block in the memory of the computing device; to store the return address comprises to store the return address in the state control block; and to load the execution state comprises to load the execution state from the state control block.

(56) Example 13 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-12, and wherein: to execute the code in the sandbox processor mode comprises to invoke a third processor instruction to exit the first sandbox domain; and the trusted domain manager is further to execute the code included in the native domain of the first virtual address space in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to invocation of the third processor instruction.

(57) Example 14 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-13, and further comprising a processor, wherein: the processor includes a sandbox jump engine to set a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invocation of the second processor instruction; and the processor includes a sandbox exit engine to clear the sandbox bit in the memory in response to invocation of the third processor instruction.

(58) Example 15 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-14, and further comprising a processor, wherein: the processor includes a sandbox jump engine to store a return address that points to the native domain in a memory of the computing device in response to invocation of the second processor instruction; and the processor includes a sandbox exit engine to jump to the return address in response to invocation of the third processor instruction.

(59) Example 16 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-15, and further comprising: a processor that includes a sandbox enforcement engine to generate an exception during execution of the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; and a system manager to (i) execute a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generation of the exception and (ii) invoke a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to execution of the kernel exception handler; wherein the trusted domain manager is further to (i) read a sandbox status register of the processor in response to execution of the non-privileged exception handler and (ii) determine whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to reading of the sandbox status register.

(60) Example 17 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 1-16, and wherein the trusted domain manager is further to invoke, during execution of the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, the second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.

(61) Example 18 includes a method for untrusted code execution, the method comprising: executing, by a computing device, code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; invoking, by the computing device while executing the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain; invoking, by the computing device while executing the code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the first processor instruction; and executing, by the computing device, code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to invoking the second processor instruction.

(62) Example 19 includes the subject matter of Example 18, and wherein executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises: allowing, by a processor of the computing device, access to memory included in the first sandbox domain; and denying, by the processor of the computing device, access to memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(63) Example 20 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18 and 19, and wherein denying the access to memory comprises denying read access, write access, and execute access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(64) Example 21 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-20, and wherein denying the access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain comprises generating, by the processor, a page fault exception.

(65) Example 22 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-21, and wherein executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises denying, by a processor of the computing device, execution of a prohibited instruction.

(66) Example 23 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-22, and wherein denying the execution of the prohibited instruction comprises generating, by the processor, a general protection fault exception.

(67) Example 24 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-23, and further comprising: configuring, by the computing device while executing the user-mode code in the native processor mode, a sandbox state for the first sandbox domain; and invoking, by the computing device, a third processor instruction to set the sandbox state for the first sandbox domain in response to configuring the sandbox state; wherein invoking the second processor instruction comprises invoking the second processor instruction in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(68) Example 25 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-24, and wherein the sandbox state is indicative of a stack pointer that points within the first sandbox domain and an entry point within the first sandbox domain.

(69) Example 26 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-25, and further comprising configuring, by a processor of the computing device, a state control block in a memory of the computing device with the sandbox state in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(70) Example 27 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-26, and further comprising: setting, by a processor of the computing device, a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; storing, by the processor, a return address in the memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; loading, by the processor, an execution state from the memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and jumping, by the processor, to an entry point within the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the second processor instruction.

- (71) Example 28 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-27, and wherein loading the execution state comprises: loading a stack pointer from the memory to a stack pointer register of the processor; and loading the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the processor.
- (72) Example 29 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-28, and wherein: setting the sandbox bit comprises setting a sandbox bit of a state control block in the memory of the computing device; storing the return address comprises storing the return address in the state control block; and loading the execution state comprises loading the execution state from the state control block.
- (73) Example 30 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-29, and further comprising: invoking, by the computing device while executing the code in the sandbox processor mode, a third processor instruction to exit the first sandbox domain; and executing, by the computing device, the code included in the native domain of the first virtual address space in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to invoking the third processor instruction.
- (74) Example 31 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-30, and further comprising: setting, by a processor of the computing device, a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and clearing, by the processor, the sandbox bit in the memory in response to invoking the third processor instruction.
- (75) Example 32 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-31, and further comprising: storing, by the processor, a return address that points to the native domain in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and jumping, by the processor, to the return address in response to invoking the third processor instruction.
- (76) Example 33 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-32, and further comprising: generating, by a processor of the computing device, an exception while executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; executing, by the computing device, a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generating the exception; invoking, by the computing device, a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to executing the kernel exception handler; reading, by the computing device, a sandbox status register of the processor in response to executing the non-privileged exception handler; and determining, by the computing device, whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to reading the sandbox status register.
- (77) Example 34 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 18-33, and further comprising invoking, by the computing device while executing the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, the second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.
- (78) Example 35 includes a computing device comprising: a processor; and a memory having stored therein a plurality of instructions that when executed by the processor cause the computing device to perform the method of any of examples 18-34.
- (79) Example 36 includes one or more non-transitory, computer readable storage media comprising a plurality of instructions stored thereon that in response to being executed result in a computing device performing the method of any of examples 18-34.
- (80) Example 37 includes a computing device comprising means for performing the method of any of examples 18-34.
- (81) Example 38 includes a computing device for untrusted code execution, the computing device comprising: means for executing code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; means for invoking, by the computing device while executing the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain; means for invoking, by the computing device while executing the

code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the first processor instruction; and means for executing code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to invoking the second processor instruction.

(82) Example 39 includes the subject matter of Example 38, and wherein the means for executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises: means for allowing, by a processor of the computing device, access to memory included in the first sandbox domain; and means for denying, by the processor of the computing device, access to memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(83) Example 40 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38 and 39, and wherein the means for denying the access to memory comprises means for denying read access, write access, and execute access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain.

(84) Example 41 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-40, and wherein the means for denying the access to the memory not included in the first sandbox domain comprises means for generating, by the processor, a page fault exception.

(85) Example 42 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-41, and wherein the means for executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode comprises means for denying, by a processor of the computing device, execution of a prohibited instruction.

(86) Example 43 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-42, and wherein the means for denying the execution of the prohibited instruction comprises means for generating, by the processor, a general protection fault exception.

(87) Example 44 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-43, and further comprising: means for configuring, by the computing device while executing the user-mode code in the native processor mode, a sandbox state for the first sandbox domain; and means for invoking a third processor instruction to set the sandbox state for the first sandbox domain in response to configuring the sandbox state; wherein the means for invoking the second processor instruction comprises means for invoking the second processor instruction in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(88) Example 45 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-44, and wherein the sandbox state is indicative of a stack pointer that points within the first sandbox domain and an entry point within the first sandbox domain.

(89) Example 46 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-45, and further comprising means for configuring, by a processor of the computing device, a state control block in a memory of the computing device with the sandbox state in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(90) Example 47 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-46, and further comprising: means for setting, by a processor of the computing device, a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; means for storing, by the processor, a return address in the memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; means for loading, by the processor, an execution state from the memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and means for jumping, by the processor, to an entry point within the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the second processor instruction.

(91) Example 48 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-47, and wherein the means for loading the execution state comprises: means for loading a stack pointer from the memory to a stack pointer register of the processor; and means for loading the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the processor.

(92) Example 49 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-48, and wherein: the means for setting the sandbox bit comprises means for setting a sandbox bit of a state control block in the

memory of the computing device; the means for storing the return address comprises means for storing the return address in the state control block; and the means for loading the execution state comprises means for loading the execution state from the state control block.

(93) Example 50 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-49, and further comprising: means for invoking, by the computing device while executing the code in the sandbox processor mode, a third processor instruction to exit the first sandbox domain; and means for executing the code included in the native domain of the first virtual address space in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(94) Example 51 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-50, and further comprising: means for setting, by a processor of the computing device, a sandbox bit in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and means for clearing, by the processor, the sandbox bit in the memory in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(95) Example 52 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-51, and further comprising: means for storing, by the processor, a return address that points to the native domain in a memory of the computing device in response to invoking the second processor instruction; and means for jumping, by the processor, to the return address in response to invoking the third processor instruction.

(96) Example 53 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-52, and further comprising: means for generating, by a processor of the computing device, an exception while executing the code included in the first sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; means for executing a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generating the exception; means for invoking a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to executing the kernel exception handler; means for reading a sandbox status register of the processor in response to executing the non-privileged exception handler; and means for determining whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode in response to reading the sandbox status register.

(97) Example 54 includes the subject matter of any of Examples 38-53, and further comprising means for invoking, by the computing device while executing the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, the second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.

Claims

1. At least one computer-readable medium having stored thereon instructions which, when executed, cause a computing device to perform operations comprising: executing code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; invoking, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain, wherein, in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, loading an execution state from a memory and jumping to an entry point within the sandbox domain; and in response to invoking the first processor instruction, allowing access to the memory associated with the first sandbox domain by executing code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode.
2. The computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise invoking, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the first processor instruction.
3. The computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise: storing a return address in the memory in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, wherein loading the execution state comprises: loading a stack pointer from the memory to a stack

pointer register of the one or more processors; and loading the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the one or more processors.

4. The computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise: generating an exception during execution of the code included in the sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; (i) executing a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generation of the exception and (ii) invoking a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to execution of the kernel exception handler; and (i) reading a sandbox status register of the one or more processors in response to execution of the non-privileged exception handler and (ii) determining whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode is in response to reading of the sandbox status register.

5. The computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise invoking, during execution of the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.

6. A method comprising: executing, by a computing device, code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; invoking, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain, wherein, in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, loading an execution state from a memory and jumping to an entry point within the sandbox domain; and in response to invoking the first processor instruction, allowing access to a memory associated with the first sandbox domain by executing code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode.

7. The method of claim 6, further comprising invoking, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the first processor instruction.

8. The method of claim 6, further comprising: storing a return address in the memory in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, wherein loading the execution state comprises: loading a stack pointer from the memory to a stack pointer register of the one or more processors; and loading the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the one or more processors.

9. The method of claim 6, further comprising: generating an exception during execution of the code included in the sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; (i) executing a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generation of the exception and (ii) invoking a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to execution of the kernel exception handler; and (i) reading a sandbox status register of the one or more processors in response to execution of the non-privileged exception handler and (ii) determining whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode is in response to reading of the sandbox status register.

10. The method of claim 6, further comprising invoking, during execution of the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.

11. An apparatus comprising: processor circuitry to: execute code included in a native domain of a first virtual address space in a non-privileged, native processor mode; invoke, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a first processor instruction to add a memory page to a first sandbox domain of the first virtual address space, wherein the memory page is not included in the native domain, wherein, in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, loading an execution state from a memory and jumping to an entry point within the sandbox domain; and in response to invoking the first processor instruction, allow access to a memory associated with the first sandbox domain by executing code included in the first sandbox domain in a non-privileged, sandbox processor mode.

12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor circuitry is further to: invoke, while executing the code in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the first sandbox domain in response to invoking the first processor instruction.
13. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor circuitry is further to: store a return address in the memory in response to the invocation of the first processor instruction, wherein loading the execution state comprises: load a stack pointer from the memory to a stack pointer register of the one or more processors; and load the entry point from the memory to an instruction pointer register of the one or more processors.
14. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor circuitry is further to: generate an exception during execution of the code included in the sandbox domain in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode; (i) execute a kernel exception handler in a privileged processor mode in response to generation of the exception and (ii) invoking a non-privileged exception handler in the non-privileged, native processor mode in response to execution of the kernel exception handler; and (i) read a sandbox status register of the one or more processors in response to execution of the non-privileged exception handler and (ii) determining whether the exception originated in the non-privileged, sandbox processor mode is in response to reading of the sandbox status register.
15. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor circuitry is further to invoke, during execution of the non-privileged exception handler in the native processor mode, a second processor instruction to enter the non-privileged sandbox processor mode.
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